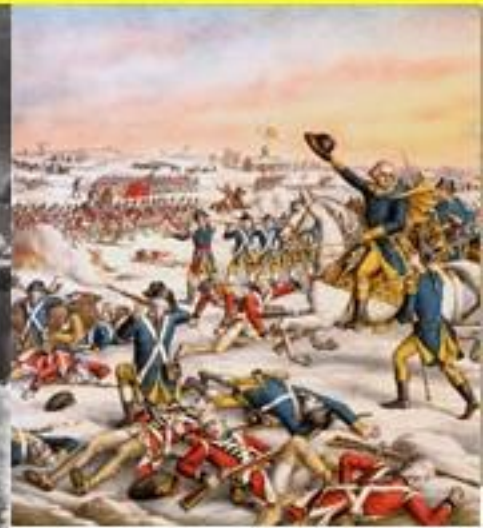


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 46

DECOLONIZATION AND NAM - 3

THIRD WORLD

1 Third World was a term originally used to distinguish nations that neither aligned with the West nor with the East during the Cold War, many were members of the Non-Aligned Movement.

2 Today, however, the term is used to denote nations with the smallest UN Human Development Index (HDI) in the world, independent of their political status.

3 These countries are also known as the Global South, developing countries, least developed countries and the Majority World.



NON-ALIGNED MOVEMENT

1 The Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) was founded in Belgrade in 1961, it was the group of newly independent states which envisioned keeping the pressure politics of bi-polar world at an arm's length.

2 The NAM was the brain child of five eminent leaders i.e.

- Yugoslavia's president, Josip Broz Tito;
- Indonesia's first president, Sukarno;
- Egypt's second president, Gamal Abdel Nasser;
- Ghana's first president Kwame Nkrumah;
- and India's first Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru.



BACKGROUND

- 1** After the Second World War the world got polarized into two rival blocs i.e. the one led by US and the other led by erstwhile Soviet Union.
- 2** It was also the time when many of Asian, Africa and South American countries freed themselves from the yoke of colonial powers and gained freedom.
- 3** These newly independent countries were often lured and pressurized by the two rival blocs to make them fall under their shape of influence.
- 4** During that period the antagonism between the two rival blocs was high and they use to leave no stone unturned to influence the foreign policy of these newly independent countries as per their own interests and to contain and curtail the influence of the rival block. It was in this context the NAM was found.



BACKGROUND

1 PURPOSE

a The purpose of NAM in the words of Cuban leader Fidel Castro was to ensure the national independence, Sovereignty, territorial integrity and security of non-aligned countries in their struggle against imperialism, colonialism, neo-colonialism, racism, and all forms of foreign aggression, occupation, domination, interference or hegemony as well as against great power and bloc politics.

b The NAM does not envision passive neutrality for its members in the foreign diplomacy but active influence and participation in the geopolitics and international diplomacy.

c However, the NAM envisages insulating its members from blocks politics, pressure and hegemony of the two superpowers.



BACKGROUND

ii

GOAL

- The primary goal of NAM members is to act on the basis of their respective national to decide the future course about an international or bilateral issue, rather than pressure or influence of any kind from the blocs.

5

The countries of the Non-Aligned Movement represent nearly two-thirds of the United Nation's members contain 55% of the world population.

6

Membership is particularly concentrated in countries considered to be developing or part of the Third World.



RELEVANCE OF NAM IN POST-COLD WAR ERA

- 1** After the disintegration of erstwhile Soviet Union in 1991-92, according to some critics the NAM has also lost its relevance as it was formed as an attempt to thwart the Cold War.
- 2** According to these critics, the NAM was based on “the relics of bloc politics” and with the end of bloc politics the movement has lost the relevance.
- 3** Nonetheless, the idea that after the Cold War the NAM has lost its relevance lacks merit.
- 4** The protagonist for the NAM have visualized the continued relevance of NAM as a forum to facilitate coordination and cooperation among developing countries, on issues of interest to them.



RELEVANCE OF NAM IN POST-COLD WAR ERA

- 5** It's true that imperialism, colonialism and bloc politics have ceased to be formidable challenges for the third world countries and hegemony has not ended in the world.

In this context, the NAM is still relevant in the following ways:

1 MULTI-POLAR WORLD

The third world countries are now facing the great threat of hegemony of unipolar world; there is a growing need to align the third world countries for a multi-polar world.

2 NEW CHALLENGES

The challenges like imperialism and colonialism have taken the new avatars for the third world countries in the form of neo-imperialism and neo-colonialism.



3

INFLUENCE OF RICH COUNTRIES ON INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

- a** The influence of rich countries in the policies of international financial institutions like World Bank and IMF is gradually increasing.
- b** These institutions have become assertive in promoting the agenda of reforms and liberalization in the world.
- c** The cooperation among the third world countries have become essential so that developmental objectives in these countries are not compromised in the guise of reforms.



RELEVANCE OF NAM IN POST-COLD WAR ERA

4 CLIMATE CHANGE

- a** It is another formidable challenge where the third world countries have the common agenda.
- b** The inventory of Green House gases has been piled up by the rich countries.
- c** Thus the NAM can have relevance in advocating for just principles like “Common but differential responsibilities”.



5 DOMINANCE OF USA AND ITS ALLIES

- a** After the collapse of the Soviet Union and its communist allies, the UN has almost completely been dominated by the powerful nations like the US and its allies.
- b** The UN's ability to provide a check on these powerful nations is doubtful now.
- c** Thus the NAM can play a dynamic role in this context.
- d** The Tehran Summit of the NAM, 2012 is a case in point where the solidarity of the NAM countries with Iran gave Tehran a big-diplomatic leverage against the US and Israel on the nuclear energy issue.



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Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

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